GGG-N-185a
October 21, 1964
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. GGG-N-00185 (GSA-FSS)
January 15, 1964

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

NEEDLE, CABLE LACING

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. The needle covered by this specification is a tool used for lacing or sewing cable such as that used for communication equipment.

1.1.1 *Federal specification coverage.* Federal specifications do not include all varieties of the commodity as indicated by the title of the specification, or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover only those generally used by the Federal Government.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Type and size.* This specification covers one type and size of cable lacing needle as hereinafter specified.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation to bid or request for proposal, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-566—Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636—Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665—Boxes; Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).
PPP-B-676—Boxes, Set-Up, Paperboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).
Fed. Std. No. 151—Metals; Test Methods.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-H-15424—Hand Tools, Packaging of.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105—Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 **Illustration.** Except for dimensional requirements specified, the illustration herein is descriptive and not restrictive and is not intended to preclude the purchase of cable lacing needles otherwise conforming to this specification.

3.2 **Components.** The cable lacing needle shall consist of a handle and blade (needle).

3.2.1 *Handle.* The handle shall be formed from a strip of corrosion-resistant metal, steel, or anodized aluminum looped to form a handle. Surfaces of the handle where the blade (needle) is inserted shall be flat in order to provide a snug fit between handle and blade(needle). The handle shall be smoothly finished in a manner to provide a comfortable finger grip by the user.

3.2.2 *Blade (needle).* The blade (needle) shall be made of spring steel properly hardened and tempered. One end shall be fastened between the ends of the handle loop with at least two rivets, screws or similar fasteners to prevent turning or loosening in the handle under service conditions. The opposite end of the blade (needle) shall be radiused and notched to facilitate pulling and lacing of wires.

3.3 **Dimensions.** The cable lacing needle shall conform to the dimensions of figure 1.

3.4 **Hardness.** The blade (needle) shall show a Rockwell C hardness range of 40 to 50.

3.5 **Finish.** The tool shall be free from any defects such as burrs, cracks or other detrimental defects. All edges shall be smoothly finished in accordance with good commercial practice.

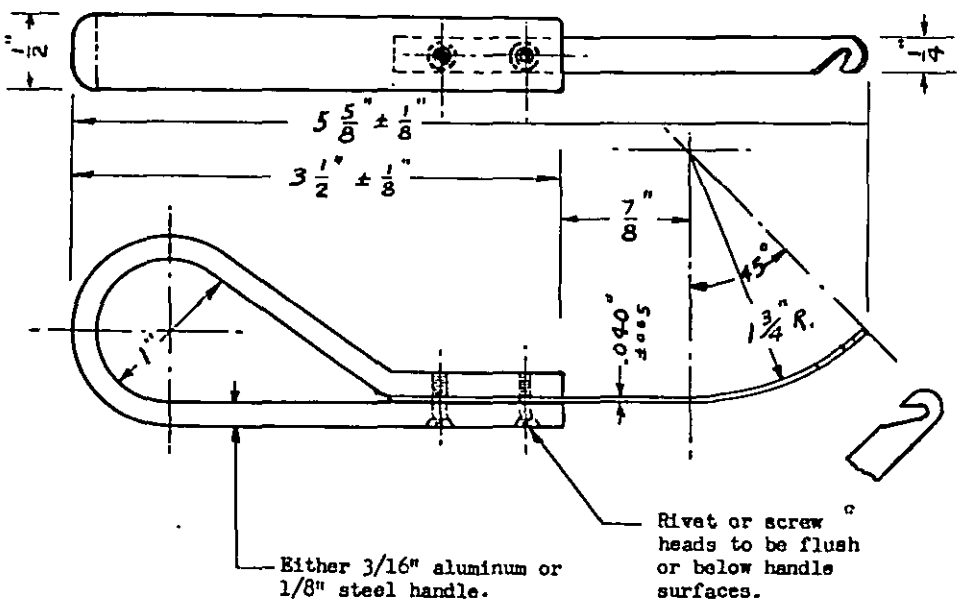


Figure 1. Cable lacing needle.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling for quality conformance inspection. Sampling for quality conformance inspection shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105.

4.2.1 *Hardness.* Needles shall be tested as described in 4.3. A lot shall consist of tools with blades (needles) heat treated as a batch or under the same process and control. The sample unit shall be one cable lacing needle. The inspection level shall be level II with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 1.5 defects per hundred units.

4.2.2 *Inspection of end item.* Inspection of the cable lacing needles shall be performed as specified in 4.2.2.1 and 4.2.2.2. The sample unit shall be one completely fabricated and assembled tool.

4.2.2.1 *Visual examination.* Each sample unit shall be visually examined for the defects specified below. The inspection level shall be level II with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

Examination	Defects
Components:	
Handle	Not of specified material or design.
Blade	Not of specified material.
	Improperly fastened or loose in handle.
	Not radiused and notched.
Finish	Not smooth, scratches, or nicks.
	Evidence of rust.

4.2.2.2 *Dimensional examination.* Each sample unit shall be examined for dimensions specified in figure 1. Any deviation therefrom shall constitute a defect. The inspection level shall be level II with an acceptable AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

4.3 Hardness test. Each sample unit selected in accordance with 4.2.1 shall be tested to determine compliance with 3.4. Test shall be conducted in accordance with method 243.1 of Fed. Std. 151.

4.4 Examination of preparation for delivery. Inspection to determine compliance with preparation for delivery shall be made in accordance with MIL-H-15424 for "Awls".

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(Civil agencies should refer to Fed. Std. 102 for definitions and applications of the various levels of packaging protection for supplies and equipment.)

5.1 Cleaning, preservation, and packaging. Cleaning, preservation and packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 *Level A.* Cable lacing needles shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with level A of MIL-H-15424 for "Awls".

5.1.2 *Level B.* Twelve needles, in individual kraft or glassine envelopes, shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-566; PPP-B-665; or to PPP-B-676. Each box shall be closed and sealed in accordance with the applicable box specification or appendix thereto.

5.1.3 *Level C.* Preservation and packaging which will afford adequate protection against corrosion, deterioration, and damage during shipment from supply source to the first receiving activity for immediate use (vendor to user).

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.2.1 *Level A.* Cable lacing needles, packaged as specified (see 5.1), shall be packed in accordance with level A of MIL-H-15424 for "Awls".

5.2.2 *Level B.* Cable lacing needles shall be packed in accordance with level B of MIL-H-15424.

5.2.3 *Level B, standard pack (civil agencies.).* Twelve unit packages of needles, packaged as specified in 5.1.3, shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, type I, class 1, style RSC. Each box shall be closed and sealed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.4 *Level C.* Packing which will afford protection against damage during direct shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity for immediate use.

5.2.5 *Standard pack (civil agency procurements).* The standard pack for civil agency procurements shall be as specified in 5.1.2 and 5.2.3 (see 6.2).

5.3 **Marking.**

5.3.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. 123.

5.3.2 *Military agencies.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. **NOTES**

6.1 **Ordering data.** Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein, and procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(*b*) Levels of preservation, packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(*c*) Special marking, if required (see 5.3).

6.2 **Standard pack for civil agencies.** The standard pack requirements in 5.2.5 are intended for use in procurements of stores stock replenishments. Procuring officers should use the standard pack requirements when it is known that the material will be shipped from a supplier to a domestic warehouse, supply depot or intermediate storage point for temporary storage, subsequent issue and/or shipment to eventual user.

6.3 **Transportation description.** Transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Rail:

Tools, not otherwise indexed by name.
Carload minimum weight 30,000 pounds.

Motor:

Tools, hand, other than power.
Carload minimum weight 30,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

DOD coordination has been waived

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:38Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.